

Cross-references

Calepin supports three mechanisms for specifying labels: arguments in the `#calepin.chunk()` function, `#|` Quarto-style syntax at the top of the code block, and a compact trailing label on plain executable fences. Use Quarto-style prefixes so Calepin knows what the label refers to; `fig-` labels attach to figure output.

label argument

Single figure

In prose we mention `@fig-cross-scatter`.

```
#calepin.chunk(label: "fig-cross-scatter", fig-caption: [Miles per gallon and horsepower],)[
  ``r
plot(mpg ~ hp, data = mtcars)
  ``]
```

In prose we mention Figure 1.

```
plot(mpg ~ hp, data = mtcars)
```

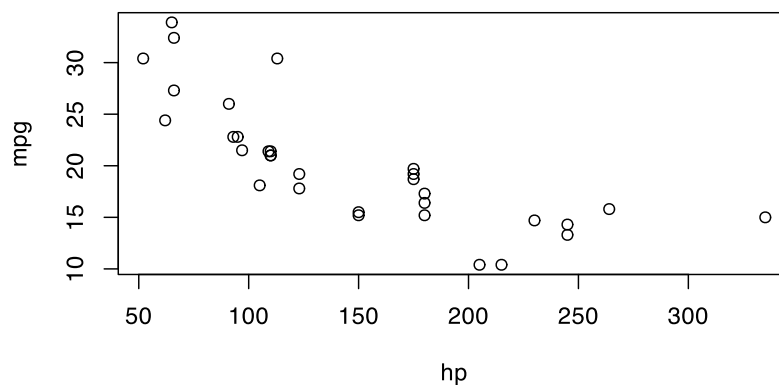


Figure 1: Miles per gallon and horsepower

#| syntax

Quarto-style `#| label:`

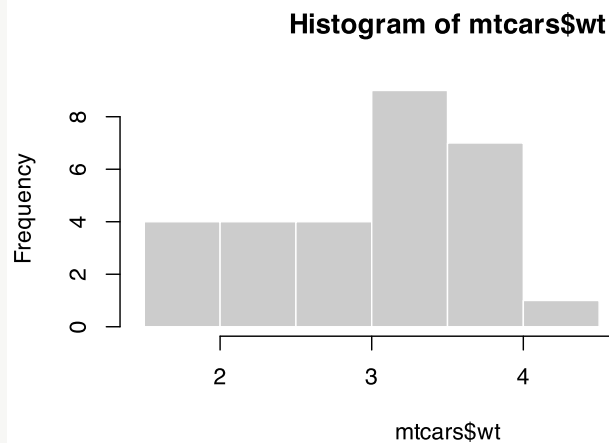
Put `#| label:` at the top of the code block when you want the label next to other executable-code options.

In prose we mention `@fig-cross-qmd`.

```
``r
#| fig-caption: Distribution of car weights
#| label: fig-cross-qmd
hist(mtcars$wt, col = "gray80", border = "white")
``
```

In prose we mention Figure 2.

```
hist(mtcars$wt, col = "gray80", border = "white")
```



Trailing fence labels

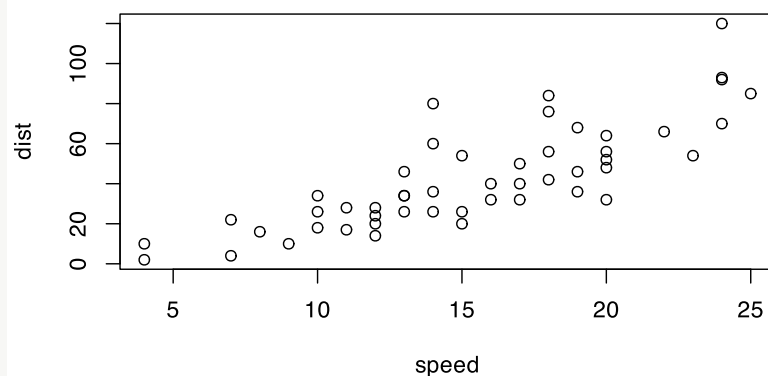
For plain executable fences, you can also put a single routed label after the closing fence. This is equivalent to a single `#| label: header`, but more compact.

In prose we mention `@fig-cross-trailing`.

```
```\r\nplot(dist ~ speed, data = cars)\r\n```<fig-cross-trailing>
```

In prose we mention Figure 3.

```
plot(dist ~ speed, data = cars)
```



## Label rules

Use recognized prefixes so Calepin knows where the label belongs:

Prefix	Target	Status
fig-	Figure or plot output	Supported.

<code>tbl-</code>	Table output	Reserved for table cross-references in a later milestone.
<code>lst-</code>	Code listing output	Reserved for listing cross-references in a later milestone.

## Roadmap

Future cross-reference work includes independent labels for subcaptioned panels, so multi-plot figures can support references such as `@fig-name-2` or rendered forms like “Figure 2b”. That requires subfigure semantics: each panel needs a stable label, numbering, and rendering behavior instead of only caption text inside a shared figure grid.

Unprefixed labels such as `label: "myplot"` are rejected. Panel labels such as `@fig-name-2` are planned for a later milestone.

Trailing fence labels are strict and single-label only. Use exactly one of `label:`, `#| label:`, or a trailing fence label for any one chunk.

Multiple label kinds are also reserved for later milestones. The planned form is a label list such as `label: ("fig-name", "lst-name")`, where one chunk can carry labels for more than one output kind. Table labels with the `tbl-` prefix and listing labels with the `lst-` prefix are classified and can appear in chunk metadata today, but only `fig-` labels are attached to rendered figure output in this milestone.